HOW WE BUILT PAC-MAN

The retrospective project story | 05 May — 20 Oct 2026

01
MAY
Prototype
Anaïs

02
AUG
Planning & baseline
Mario

03
SEP
Compliance & core
Both

04
OCT
Finish & release
Both

The important historical correction

Git did not begin with PR #13. Anaïs committed the initial project on 5 May, then implemented its main gameplay and UI components through 9 May. PR #13 formalised project governance much later, on 22–23 August.

Evidence boundary: a PR creator or commit author is not a measure of effort.
Shared changes are represented as collaboration, not reassigned ownership.
No planned baseline dates are invented: this is an actual-delivery reconstruction.

WHO DELIVERED WHAT

Modules and outcomes derived from the first code snapshot and merged PRs

ANAÏS / FOUNDATION

Game engine, player and ghosts

Maze integration and levels

Screens, HUD and menus

Initial images and audio

PR #17: graphic API audit

PR #26: evaluator mechanics

PR #27: collision regression tests

MARIO / COMPLETION

PR #13–14: governance and quality

CLI, configuration and audio resilience

Maze seeds, scoring and progression

Persistent highscores

Ghost refinement and UI polish

Windows and Linux packaging

PR #31–33: evidence and release

COLLABORATION

PR #17: audit and final integration

PR #23: scoring plus music update

PR #26: evaluator and new sprites

Release: team confirmation

Reviews and merges across branches

Decision process: pending validation

Attribution of early modules: evidence from file trees and May commits; detailed authorship reflects Git records.

DELIVERY CONTROL & EVIDENCE

Project-management chapter VIII | Traceability • Decisions • Risks • Acceptance

Initial game
May commits

Stable base
#13–14

Compliance
#17–22

Gameplay
#23–29

Distribution
#30–33

DECISIONS

- Keep external A-Maze-ing package unchanged
- Evaluate Pygame APIs versus MLX equivalence
- Prefer incremental fixes and reproducible builds

RISKS

- Audio unavailable → silent fallback
- Unreachable maze goals → validated placements
- Portable packaged paths → app user data

ACCEPTANCE

- Automated quality and gameplay test gates
- Windows / Linux clean-clone build and startup
- Itch.io publication; upload byte identity unproven

OPEN PROCESS EVIDENCE

Team roles, decisions and conflict handling in issue #11 must be agreed by both contributors.

Source: github.com/AnaisCaire/Pac-Man | Project-management directory, May commits and PR #13–#33